

Indian gray mongoose

Herpestes edwardsii

The Indian gray mongoose is a dietary opportunist—eating lizards, eggs, and fruit as well as larger mammals such as hares and venomous cobras. Mongooses are so adept at preying on rodents and snakes that they are used as a form of pest control in some areas.

Head clamp

While its molars are used to crush insects, its strong jaws and sharp, protruding canines give the mongoose an edge when fighting snakes, allowing it to clamp onto a snake's head and puncture its skull. Although not

immune to snake venom, highly reactive reflexes help them avoid being bitten. Mongooses are solitary except during mating season. Females bear litters of two to four pups up to three times a year.

Mongooses **crack large eggs by throwing** them between their hindlegs **against a hard surface**

short, rounded ears
closed in dusty places

